Conservation International (CI) is an American non-profit environmental organization founded in 1987 in Virginia. Its goal is to protect nature as a source for food, fresh water, livelihood and a stable climate.

CI has helped to support 1,200 protected areas across 77 countries, safeguarding more than 601 million hectares of marine and coastal areas.

- Least concern (lc) – Lowest risk widespread and abundant
- Conservation dependent (cd) – This group has now merged with near threatened.
- Data deficient (dd) – Not enough data to assess the risk of extinction of the species.
- Not evaluated (ne) – Species not yet been evaluated against the criteria.

In the context of the IUCN Red List, 'threatened' embraces the three categories of Critically Endangered, Endangered, and Vulnerable.

According to the IUCN those species that have dwindled drastically are called as Critically Endangered and are included as Red List. Species that have disappeared are called as extinct species. In the Red List of 2012 that was released on 19 July 2012 at Rio+20 Earth Summit 19,817 species were threatened with extinction.



A Hawaiian plant species called Alula locally referred to as cabbage on a stick has moved from Critically Endangered to Extinct in the Wild. It is one of the 38 Red Listed Hawaiian plant species with less than five wild individuals remaining. It used to grow on the windy sea cliffs of Kauai. Alula was destroyed by hurricanes

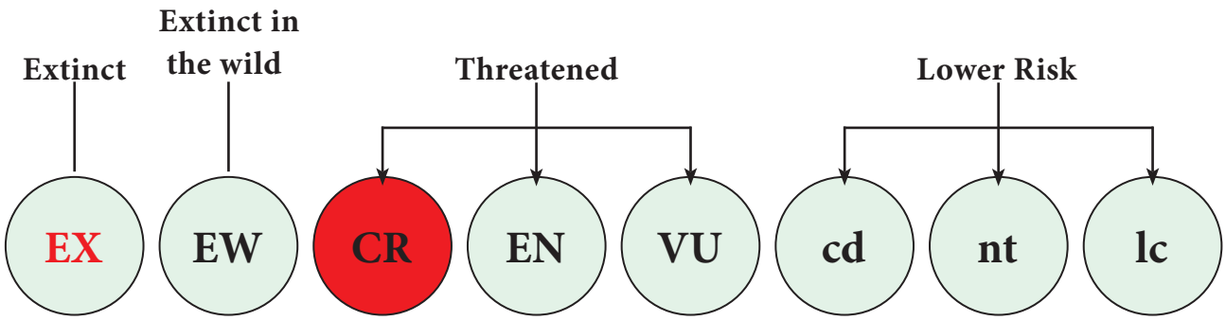


Figure 7.11 Species Classification by IUCN

TN_Govt_Geography_XI_Std Unit_07.indd 203 15-12-2021 17:25:36